

ENG524 SHORT HANDOUTS

MIDTERM

Lesson 06 to 10

(ENG 524) CRITICAL DISCOURSE ANALYSIS

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Lecture-06

CDA and Context

Topic-01: Definition of Context

How does Blommaert define context?

Blommaert defines context as "the totality of conditions under which discourse is being produced, circulated, and interpreted."

According to Van Dijk, what are the elements that make up context?

Van Dijk defines context as "the cognitive, social, political, cultural, and historical environments of discourse."

What metaphors were used in early approaches to depict context?

Early approaches used metaphors such as "figure as text" and "ground as context."

What are the components of context according to Halliday & Hasan (1985)?

Halliday & Hasan distinguish text, co-text, context of situation, and context of culture.

How is the relationship between text and context described?

Text and context are described as being in a "mutually reflexive" relationship, where each influences the other.

What is contextualization, and how is it related to meaning?

Contextualization is the process by which text and context come together to create meaning.

According to van Dijk, what regulates contextualization?

Contextualization is regulated by the 'K-device,' which is the mutual knowledge shared by the speaker and hearer.

How is the dynamic nature of context described?

Context is described as dynamic and changing as the discourse progresses.

What is intertextuality, and why is it important in CDS?

Intertextuality is the process whereby textual features of one text reappear in another, and it is important in CDS because it links different texts together.

Why is identity considered an important contextual factor?

Identity is important because the image one has of oneself or others affects the interpretation of actions and motivations.

Topic-02: Early Models of Context

How did Malinowski emphasize the role of context in language?

Malinowski stated that a word without linguistic context is meaningless, and context is essential for interpretation.

What distinction did Firth and Halliday make regarding context?

Firth and Halliday distinguished between the context of situation and the broader context of culture.

What is the Sapir-Whorf hypothesis, and how does it relate to context?

The Sapir-Whorf hypothesis suggests that the culture underlying a language represents the context within which that language is interpreted.

What is Hymes's speaking mnemonic, and what are its components?

Hymes's speaking mnemonic includes components like setting, participants, ends, act sequence, key, instrumentalities, norms, genre, and pragmatics.

How does Grice's cooperative principle relate to context in communication?

Grice's cooperative principle emphasizes that the interpretation of utterances is an inferential process based on rational thought and context.

Topic-03: Recent Models of CDA

How does Conversation Analysis (CA) view context?

CA views context as constructed moment by moment through conversational moves.

What are the two views of CA regarding context?

There is a strong view (Schegloff) that emphasizes the evidence of context within the sequence of speaker turns and a weaker view (Drew and Heritage) that looks at the institutional context.

What are the three dimensions of context in Systemic Functional Linguistics (SFL)?

The three dimensions are field of discourse, tenor of discourse, and mode of discourse.

How does SFL enable critical discourse analysts to relate language form to context?

SFL allows analysts to identify form-function links and relate language form to context.

What is the central aspect of communication in ethnographic approaches?

Social context is the central aspect of communication in ethnographic approaches.

How does Cognitive Linguistics view context?

Cognitive Linguistics views context as mental models constructed in the cognitive systems of interacting group members.

What does Corpus Linguistics study in the text/context interface?

Corpus Linguistics studies the use of language in a specific context compared to a reference corpus to show variations in language use.

What is Multi-Modal Discourse Analysis (MMDA) concerned with?

MMDA is concerned with analyzing all semiotic systems, not just language, and how they are deployed for ideological purposes.

Who pioneered MMDA, and what does it focus on?

MMDA was pioneered by Kress and van Leeuwen and focuses on the re-contextualization of social practices for ideological purposes.

Lecture-07

CDA and Genre (I)

Topic-01: Introduction of Genre

What are genres in language and discourse?

Genres are ways in which people 'get things done' through their use of spoken and written discourse. They involve using language in specific ways based on content, purpose, and audience.

How does the use of language in a genre relate to social and cultural context?

Language use in a genre is influenced by the social and cultural context in which it is used. Different genres may emerge in response to changes in technology and communication methods.

Who defines genre according to Martin (1984)?

Martin defines genre as 'a staged, goal-oriented, purposeful activity in which speakers engage as members of our culture.'

What is the key concept in Miller's (1984) view of genre?

In Miller's view, a genre is defined by the action it is used to accomplish, rather than by the form or content of discourse.

What is typification in the context of genre, according to Miller?

Typification refers to the typical forms, content, and actions associated with a genre, which writers and speakers draw on as they engage with the use of genres.

Explain the concept of "typification" in the context of genre, and how does it influence the way genres are recognized and used?

Typification in the context of genre refers to the typical forms, content, and actions associated with a particular genre. These typical elements are recognized and relied upon by individuals as they engage with the use of genres. Genres often have characteristic structures and patterns, both in terms of content and how actions are carried out. These typifications serve as a guide for users, allowing them to understand and navigate the genre effectively. For instance, when someone encounters a specific genre, they draw on their knowledge of

typical forms and actions associated with that genre to communicate effectively within it. This notion of typification helps shape the way genres are recognized, used, and shared among individuals in a given cultural and social context.

Topic-02: Choice and Constraints in the Use of Genre

How do Devitt and Swales view genres in terms of choices and constraints?

They view genres as having both choices and constraints, with regularity and chaos. Genres are dynamic and open to change, but there are expected ways of acting within them.

According to Bhatia, what analogy does he use to describe the art of genre?

Bhatia describes practicing a genre as being like playing a game with its own rules and conventions, where writers and readers skillfully manipulate and exploit the genre for specific purposes.

Why is it important to learn the rules of the genre game, according to Bhatia?

Learning the rules of the genre game is important to exploit and manipulate genres effectively to achieve professional and disciplinary goals.

Topic-03: Relationship between Genres

How can the use of one genre depend on other interrelated genres, as per Paltridge?

Paltridge suggests that the use of one genre may assume or depend on the use of a number of other interrelated genres. For example, an academic essay may draw from academic lectures, texts, and journal articles.

Provide an example of how genre requirements can differ for students in different fields.

In the context of law and MBA students' final assessments, Uhrig found that different genres were important. For law students, summaries of legal cases were crucial, while MBA students valued class discussions and oral presentations.

Topic-04: Genre Analysis and Various Forms of Writing

What is the CARS framework used for in genre analysis, according to Feak and Swales?

The CARS (Create a research space) framework is used to describe the typical discourse structure of the Introduction section of research articles. It shows how authors establish the importance of their research, identify gaps in previous research, and explain how their study fills those gaps.

What are some examples of academic genres examined in recent studies?

Recent studies have examined research articles, theses, dissertations, job application letters, sales promotion letters, legislative documents, academic lectures, poster session discussions, and student assignments.

Topic-05: Steps in Genre Analysis

What is the first step in analyzing a genre, according to Bhatia?

The first step is to collect samples of the genre the researcher is interested in, which may include randomly chosen texts, a single typical text, or a larger sample of texts.

Why is it important to consider what is already known about a particular genre?

Considering existing knowledge about a genre helps researchers understand the conventions, settings, and purposes associated with that genre.

What aspects of a genre should be defined in the analysis, including the writer, audience, and purpose?

Researchers need to define the writer, audience, and their relationship, as well as the goal or purpose of the texts, to understand the genre fully.

Topic-06: The Social and Cultural Context of Genres

What factors related to the setting of a text should be examined in context analysis, according to Paltridge?

Factors include the kind of university, level of study, type of degree, and the field of study (e.g., hard or soft, pure or applied).

Why is understanding the purpose of a text important in context analysis?

Understanding the purpose of a text helps in recognizing why writers write in that genre and what goals they aim to achieve.

How does the audience, role, and purpose in reading a text affect the analysis?

The audience, role, and purpose in reading a text determine how readers assess the quality of the research and what criteria they use for evaluation.

What is meant by the "values, beliefs, and assumptions" in context analysis?

It refers to the underlying values and beliefs that writers and readers share and the issues they should address in a particular genre.

How is the relationship of the text to other texts considered in genre analysis?

Researchers examine how a text relates to other texts, how it acknowledges previous research, and what constitutes valid previous research. They also look at acceptable and unacceptable textual borrowings.

Lecture-08

CDA and Genre (II)

Topic-01: The Discourse Structure of Genres

How can the discourse structure of genres be analyzed?

The discourse structure of genres can be analyzed by identifying generic structures and rhetorical types within the text.

What are the two different perspectives on the structure of texts?

There are two perspectives: one based on genre category membership and another based on rhetorical organization.

How many different types of patterns for theses and dissertations are typically identified?

There are at least four different types of patterns that writers typically choose from for theses and dissertations.

What are the four thesis and dissertation types mentioned?

They are 'simple traditional,' 'complex traditional,' 'topic-based,' and 'compilations of research articles.'

What did Paltridge focus on in his analysis of a doctoral dissertation abstract?

Paltridge focused on the analysis of an abstract from a doctoral dissertation in terms of both its generic and rhetorical structures.

What is the genre of the text presented as an example in this topic?

The text is presented as an example of a problem–solution text.

Can you explain how the discourse structure of genres can be analyzed, and what are the key factors involved in this analysis?

Analyzing the discourse structure of genres involves various key factors. First, it can be examined by identifying generic structures, which are often based on the genre category membership of the text. For example, one can distinguish between genres like "letter to the editor" and "doctoral dissertation" based on their generic structures. Another approach involves looking at rhetorical types within the text, such as argument, description, and problem-solution, which can occur in various genres.

There are two distinct perspectives on the structure of texts within this analysis. The first perspective identifies the text's generic structure based on its genre category, while the second perspective describes the text's rhetorical structure based on the patterning of rhetorical organization within it.

Topic-02: Current theory and research in genre analysis-1

What is the relationship between linguistic choices and social functions of language according to Chouliaraki and Fairclough?

Linguistic choices are related to all major social functions of language, transmitting meta-functions.

Why is it important to analyze the relationship between textual features and social expectations in genre analysis?

Analyzing this relationship helps understand how texts adjust to social expectations and disseminate ideological beliefs.

How are genres defined in this context?

Genres are defined as global linguistic patterns developed historically in a linguistic community for specific communicative tasks.

What is the role of political genres in CDA?

Political genres play a role in the exercise of power and influence in the definition of politics and political institutions.

What is the impact of new communication paradigms on political genres?

New communication paradigms, such as text and video commenting, have altered the reception and accessibility of political genres.

Topic-03: Current Theory and Research in Genre Analysis II

What types of political genres are discussed in this topic Current Theory and Research in Genre Analysis II?

Speeches, debates, interviews, and their reshaping through new media are discussed.

How have new communication paradigms changed the reception of political genres?

New paradigms like text and video commenting have altered the reception of political genres by encouraging user-mediated interaction.

Why is the role of "authorship" questioned in relation to political genres?

The intensity of migration into new media has blurred the distinction of authorship in political genres.

How does the study by Llamas show the relation between different political genres?

Llamas' study demonstrates the establishment of relations between multiple political genres within a single political campaign.

What is an example of polysemy mentioned in this topic?

The word "deal" is used with both political and metaphorical meanings, affecting the interpretation of the peace agreement.

Topic-04: Application of Genre Analysis

What is the argument presented by Hammond and Macken Horarick regarding genre-based teaching?

They argue that genre-based teaching can help students access texts and participate more successfully in second language interactions.

What is the concern raised by Luke regarding teaching 'genres of power'?

Luke is concerned that teaching such genres may lead to uncritical reproduction of text and may not provide the intended access for learners.

What should teachers consider when using a genre-based approach in teaching?

Teachers should consider helping students bring their individual voices into their use of genres and avoid over-generalization.

According to Tardy, what is the significance of genre-based teaching in both first and second language contexts?

Genre theory has evolved beyond 'text types' and is now seen as a social construct shaping and being shaped by human activity.

What is the importance of genre awareness and rhetorical flexibility for students in genre-based teaching?

Students need to develop both genre awareness and rhetorical flexibility to meet the expectations of different genres and settings.

What purpose do genres serve in communication?

Genres provide a frame that enables people to participate in and interpret specific communicative events, and explicit knowledge of genres can empower learners in particular situations.

Lecture-09

Sir Zahid

Multimodality and CDA

Topic-01: What is Multi-modality?

What is multi-modality in the context of CDA?

Multi-modality in CDA refers to the integration of visual, sound, and material design alongside textual analysis.

Why is multi-modal CDA still considered in its infancy?

Multi-modal CDA is still in its infancy because it lacks clear, robust concepts and a unified framework.

Name a few books and journal editions that combine multi-modality with CDA.

Mayr and Machin (2012), Machin and Mayr (2012), Djonov and Zhao (2014), Abousnnouga and Machin (2013), and Machin (2013).

How does multi-modality relate to power relations and ideologies in texts?

Multi-modality is used to reveal power relations and ideologies in texts by examining how various semiotic resources are employed for communication and ideological work.

Can you explain the concept of multi-modality in Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA)?

Multi-modality in the context of CDA refers to the integration of various modes of communication, such as visual, sound, and material design, alongside the analysis of textual elements. While it has gained recognition, it is still considered a field in its infancy. Several scholars have introduced multi-modality alongside CDA, aiming to uncover the underlying power relations and ideologies within texts. However, multi-modality remains fragmented, and there's a need to develop clear and robust concepts that align with CDA's emphasis on revealing discourses embedded in texts.

Topic-02: Origins/background of Multimodality

What books are considered foundational in the field of multi-modality?

"Reading Images" by Kress and van Leeuwen (1996) and "The Language of Displayed Art" by O'Toole (1994).

How did Michael Halliday's work influence the development of multi-modality?

Halliday's emphasis on the social use of language and the shift away from rigid grammar contributed to the social interpretation of language and its meanings in multi-modality.

How do "Reading Images" and "The Language of Displayed Art" extend the interpretation of language to visual communication?

These books use semiotic resources to create situated meaning and analyze the ideologies and values they carry in institutional contexts.

Topic-03: Approaches to MDA

What is the cognitive approach in multi-modality, and who inspired it?

The cognitive approach studies visual metaphors in various media, inspired mainly by Forceville's work (1996).

What is Interactional Analysis in multi-modality, and who developed it?

Interactional Analysis focuses on the interplay of different semiotic resources in social interactions, developed mainly by Scollon and Norris (2004, 2011).

How does multi-modality differ from a language-centered approach to meaning making?

Multi-modality shifts away from language as the sole site of meaning making and explores the use of various semiotic resources in communication.

Topic-04: Criticism of Multimodality

What criticism is leveled against multi-modality concerning the use of terms?

Critics argue that there is a lack of consistency in how terms are used, with authors often creating their own unique meanings.

What critique suggests that multi-modal analysis may produce descriptive concepts but lack clear insights?

Reynolds (2012) expressed concern that multi-modal analysis might fall short in providing clear insights and actionable knowledge.

How does multi-modality avoid tunnel vision, according to critics?

Critics argue that multi-modality should avoid the tunnel vision of relying on a single theory of language and engage with fields like film studies and media studies for better organization.

Topic-05: The Re-contextualization of Social Practice

What is meant by the re-contextualization of social practice?

Re-contextualization involves examining how social practices are represented in language through substitutions, additions, deletions, and re-ordering of events.

How does re-contextualization help reveal buried ideologies in multi-modal analysis?

Re-contextualization allows for a critical analysis of how different semiotic resources are used to communicate ideologies in different social practices.

How has the trend in universities changed with regard to promotional tools?

Universities have increasingly focused on promotional tools to attract more audiences and demonstrate accountability.

Why are some critics concerned about the use of promotional tools in universities?

Critics argue that using such tools may divert universities from their core activities, making them more focused on business targets and management language.

Lecture-10

Multi-Modality and CDA (II)

Topic-01: Example of MMDA

What are the different modes of communication, besides language, that people use?

People use modes such as images, gesture, gaze, and posture for communication.

How does the potential of a particular mode for communication get shaped?

The potential of a mode is shaped by how it has been used in context, its repeated meanings, and social conventions.

In MMDA, what type of modes often receive special attention?

Images, including photographs, diagrams, maps, and cartoons, often receive special attention in MMDA.

How can an image's composition influence the viewer's perception?

Factors like eye contact, perspective, shot distance, lighting, color, and focus can influence the viewer's perception.

Topic-02: A Social Semiotic Theory of Multimodality

According to social semiotic theory, what are some of the semiotic resources used for communication?

Semiotic resources include gestures, images, and music.

What are the four theoretical assumptions underlying multimodal discourse analysis?

The assumptions are:

1. Different modes contribute to meaning.
2. Each mode realizes different meanings.
3. People select and configure modes to make meaning.

4. Meanings from multimodal resources are shaped by social norms and conventions.

What does a social-semiotic theory of multimodality aim to answer about a text?

It aims to answer questions like: What meaning is being made? How is meaning being made? What resources are used? In what social environment is the meaning being made?

Topic-03: Genre and Multimodality Framework

What are the various structures considered within a genre and multimodality framework?

The structures include content, genre, rhetorical, linguistic, layout, and navigation structures.

How does color play a role in the genre and multimodality framework?

Color can contribute to the overall meaning of a text; for example, it can suggest warmth, energy, or salience.

What does the relationship between the image and the text contribute to in the genre framework?

The relationship between the image and the text can create intermodal complementarity, meaning that they belong together and strengthen the message.

Topic-04: Multimodality and Newspaper Genre

What are newsbites in the context of newspaper genre analysis?

Newsbites are brief news stories containing a headline, image, and a link to a full story, used to highlight important news.

How do newspapers use idiomatic expressions in headings?

Newspapers use idiomatic expressions to connect culturally and socially with their readers.

What are the three components of image-nuclear news stories in newspapers?

The three components are the heading, the image, and the caption.

Topic-05: Multimodality in Film and Television Genres

What levels of analysis are proposed for the analysis of films and television in the context of multimodality?

The levels include frame, shot, scene, sequence, generic stage, and work as a whole.

What is the relationship between genre and specific stages in film genres?

Each genre has a specific set of stages, such as orientation, complication, resolution, and coda for narratives.

How does the composition of a frame and shot influence the message in a speech, according to Williams?

The composition of the frame and shot influences the orientation and the point of departure for the rest of the speech.

Topic-06: Carrying out MMDA

What are the steps involved in carrying out multimodal discourse analysis?

The steps involve data collection, summarization with contextual notes, analysis from a discourse perspective, and data selection.

How do Baldry and Thibault relate the analysis of television genres to context?

They relate the analysis to context of culture and context of situation, considering specific social and historical events and viewer demographics.

What is the goal of selecting an extract for analysis in MMDA?

The goal is to focus on an aspect of the data that stands out, which can then be explored further in the analysis.

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